

MAURICIO SANTOS

Brand & Communication Designer — Brand Strategy · Creative Direction. Communication Designer with 7+ years across brand strategy, marketing, service design and creative direction, now leading communication and brand management end to end.

PORTO, PORTUGAL

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mauriciosantos.design

// PROFILE

A designer at core, working today as a Communication & Brand Director. My background is in communication design (brand identity, web, editorial) and that design thinking now shapes how I lead strategy: treating communication itself as a system to be designed, not just written. Currently leading communication and brand management across six hospitality brands, connecting positioning, customer experience and commercial communication across digital and physical touchpoints.

// EXPERIENCE

Marketing & Communication Director

JAN 2023 - PRESENT
PORTO, PORTUGAL

ARMAZÉM DO PEIXE

[@armazemdopeixe.afurada](https://www.instagram.com/armazemdopeixe.afurada)

Lead communication strategy and brand management across six hospitality brands, ensuring consistent positioning, customer experience and commercial communication across digital and physical channels.

- Develop and execute integrated communication strategies across digital and physical customer touchpoints
- Lead brand positioning, messaging and creative direction across multiple brands and channels
- Manage relationships with media, strategic partners, suppliers and external agencies
- Lead copywriting for websites, campaigns, social media and email marketing

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Increased online reservations from 7.3% to 31% (+24pp) by rebuilding the digital communication and conversion strategy
- Grew the flagship restaurant's Instagram from 4,000 to 11,000+ followers (+175%) through a consistent content and brand strategy
- Unified brand positioning across 6 hospitality brands simultaneously, aligning teams and creative execution under one strategy

Marketing & Service Design Specialist

FEB 2022 - NOV 2022
LISBON, PORTUGAL

HOMA - SERVICE DESIGN

Supported communication and service design projects, connecting customer research, strategic communication and creative execution across digital and physical touchpoints.

- Connected research insights, strategic communication and creative execution across customer touchpoints
- Developed communication materials supporting service design and innovation projects
- Designed educational materials, e-books and presentations supporting client engagement

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Translated qualitative research into personas, service blueprints and journey artefacts adopted by product and service teams

Marketing Analyst

MAY 2019 - JAN 2022
FLORIANÓPOLIS, BRAZIL

ACATE - ASSOCIAÇÃO CATARINENSE DE TECNOLOGIA

Supported the communication and marketing strategy of one of Brazil's leading technology associations, connecting members, sponsors and the innovation ecosystem.

- Managed a creative/marketing team, coordinating priorities and delivery across multiple projects
- Established workflows, SLAs and sprint-based processes to structure day-to-day delivery
- Developed and launched landing pages to support campaigns and events
- Worked directly with stakeholders to translate business objectives into creative solutions

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end communication and marketing for technology companies and innovation events, from strategy to delivery
- Grew social media presence through a planned, ongoing content strategy, strengthening the association's digital footprint

Earlier experience

2017 - 2020
BRAZIL

MARKETING & DESIGN

Freelance and in-house marketing and design work, building the foundation for a later focus on communication strategy and brand management.

// SKILLS

Brand & Strategy

- Brand Strategy
- Brand Management
- Brand Positioning
- Brand Identity
- Communication Strategy
- Creative Strategy
- Creative Direction

Design

- Communication Design
- Visual Identity
- Art Direction
- Web Design
- Editorial Design
- Digital Design

Service & Customer Experience

- Service Design
- Customer Journey
- Personas
- Service Blueprints
- Customer Experience
- Design Thinking

Content & Marketing

- Content Strategy
- Copywriting
- Social Media
- Email Marketing
- Digital Marketing
- Campaigns

Tools

- Figma
- Adobe Creative Suite
- Framer
- Webflow
- HTML
- CSS
- JavaScript
- Photography
- Motion Basics
- AI Prompting

// EDUCATION

Bachelor in Communication Design

Faculdade de Belas Artes - Universidade do Porto
2015 - 2020 • GRADE 17/20

Postgraduate in Creative Advertising

Universidade Católica Portuguesa
2022 - 2022 • GRADE 20/20

Master's in Educational Sciences

FPCE - Universidade do Porto
2023 - 2025 • GRADE 18/20

// LANGUAGES

Português	Native
English	C1
Español	B1

// OTHER CERTIFICATIONS

Digital Marketing and Web Design	Imagine School (2017)
Service Design Workshop	HOMA Design (2019)
Advanced Email Marketing and Automation	RD Station (2020)
The Web Developer Bootcamp 2026 (course name)	Udemy (2024)
International Students Incentive Award 2024/2025	Universidade do Porto (best intl. average)

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